

FUTURE FOCUS

▶ **Gen Z is the market:** With nearly 380 million consumers, it already drives close to 50% of India's \$45–50 billion consumer tech market, making it the most influential cohort today

▶ **Smartphones just the starting point:** While phones remain central, Gen Z spending is rapidly shifting to wearables, audio, wellness tech, smart homes and gaming

▶ **Discovery is creator-led, validation is omnichannel:** Purchases begin on social feeds and

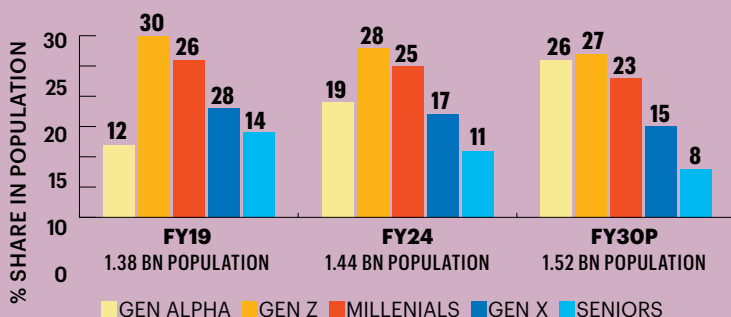
short-form video, but are sealed through experience centres, AR demos and same-day delivery

▶ **Purpose beats hype:** Gen Z will pay a premium for tech that delivers clear utility, wellness, sustainability and data transparency, but remains value-conscious

▶ **Selling to Gen Z requires a new playbook:** Winning Gen Z demands content-led funnels, creator credibility, quick commerce fulfilment and lifestyle positioning

YOUNG & POWERFUL

• By 2030, India will have 400 million Gen Z and 350 million millennials—together twice the size of the US population today



SOURCE FIRESIDE VENTURES REPORT, REDSEER

WHO WILL FUEL CONSUMER SPENDING?

YEAR	TOTAL CONSUMER SPENDING	GEN Z-DRIVEN SPENDING	% SHARE
2024	\$2 trillion	\$860 billion	43%
2030E	\$2.9 trillion	\$1.4 trillion	46%
2035E	\$3.9 trillion	\$2 trillion	50%

E IS ESTIMATE; SOURCE BCG

seeing young consumers actively questioning technology's long-term impact on health and quality of life, and they don't mind spending.

The stakes are high. As per BCG, Gen Z already influences nearly \$860 billion of consumer spending globally. That is projected to swell to \$2 trillion over the next decade. For brands, winning this generation early could translate into long-term loyalty. But there is a catch: Gen Z demands relevance, transparency and authenticity and is quick to disengage if brands fail to deliver.

MARKET AND MOMENTUM

Research rests at the heart of Gen Z's buying behaviour, though not the conventional kind. This is a generation shaped by social media, where discovery is continuous and led by creators. "Today's social media feed isn't just an ad channel; it's the new prime-time television for discovery," says Adarsh Menon, Partner at venture capital firm Fireside Ventures. "That is now at the core of how the new generation shops."

Creators, in many ways, have replaced traditional advertising. Their content—raw, relatable and experiential—carries far more credibility for Gen Z than glossy brand campaigns. A product review, a 'day-in-the-life' reel or a fitness challenge can trigger demand far more effectively than a full-page print ad.

"Gen Z's path to purchase is increasingly shaped by social feeds, short-form video and influencer cues, and then validated through omnichannel journeys and rapid fulfilment options—same day or next day—which they now expect as table stakes," says Anand Ram-anathan, Partner and Consumer Industry Leader at Deloitte India. Discovery may happen online, but confirmation often occurs offline through experience centres, in-store demos or augmented reality (AR)-led trials.